

Cleo.ai - Feature Recommendations & Roadmap

Executive Summary

Based on comprehensive testing of the Cleo.ai platform, this document outlines strategic feature recommendations to enhance user experience, increase engagement, and drive platform growth.

Phase 1: Foundation (Immediate - 4 Weeks)

1.1 Critical Bug Fixes

Privacy Page Performance Issue **Problem:** 9-second load time on privacy page

Impact: High bounce rate, user abandonment during signup

Solution: - Profile database query optimization - Implement server-side caching

- Profile database query optimization
- Implement server-side caching
- Consider static page generation for legal pages
- Add CDN caching headers

Success Metric: Load time < 2 seconds

Mobile Navigation **Problem:** No mobile-optimized navigation

Impact: 60%+ mobile users can't navigate properly

Solution:

```
Mobile Navigation Pattern:
├─ Hamburger icon (top-right)
├─ Slide-out drawer (right side)
|   └─ Logo/Brand
|   └─ How It Works
|   └─ Testimonials
|   └─ Log In
|   └─ Get Started (CTA button)
└─ Overlay backdrop (click to close)
```

Technical Implementation:

- Use Framer Motion for smooth animations
- Implement focus trap for accessibility
- Add swipe-to-close gesture
- Maintain scroll position

1.2 User Experience Enhancements

Loading States & Feedback System **Current State:** No visual feedback during actions

Desired State: Comprehensive feedback system

Components Needed:

1. Skeleton Screens

```
// For content loading
<SkeletonCard />
<SkeletonText lines={3} />
<SkeletonAvatar />
```

2. Toast Notifications

```
// Action feedback
toast.success("Profile updated successfully!")
toast.error("Something went wrong. Please try again.")
toast.info("New match available!")
```

3. Button Loading States

```
<Button loading={isSubmitting}>
  {isSubmitting ? "Creating account..." : "Get Started"}
</Button>
```

Implementation Priority:

- Form submission feedback
- Page transition loading
- Match loading states
- Profile update confirmation

Form Validation Improvements **Current Issues:**

- No real-time validation
- No password strength indicator
- Generic error messages

Enhanced Validation Flow:

```
// Password Field with Strength Indicator
<PasswordField
  validation={{
    minLength: 8,
    requireUppercase: true,
    requireNumber: true,
    requireSpecialChar: true
  }}
  showStrengthIndicator={true}
```

```
</>

// Real-time Email Validation
<EmailField
  validateOnBlur={true}
  checkAvailability={true}
  debounceMs={500}
/>
```

Validation Rules:

Field	Rules	Error Message
Email	Valid format, not registered	“Please enter a valid email” / “Email already registered”
Password	8+ chars, 1 uppercase, 1 number, 1 special	“Password must contain…”
Full Name	2+ characters	“Please enter your full name”
Confirm Password	Match password	“Passwords do not match”

Phase 2: Core Features (1-3 Months)

2.1 In-App Messaging System

User Story:

As a founder, I want to message my matched investors directly so that I can pitch my startup without leaving the platform.

Feature Requirements:

```
Messaging System Architecture:
├─ Conversation List
|   ├── Unread indicator
|   ├── Last message preview
|   ├── Timestamp
|   └─ Online status
├─ Chat Interface
|   ├── Message bubbles
|   ├── Read receipts
|   ├── Typing indicator
|   ├── File attachments (deck, one-pager)
|   └─ Message templates
├─ Notifications
|   ├── Push notifications
|   ├── Email digests
|   └─ In-app badges
└─ Privacy Controls
    ├── Block user
    └─ Report spam
```

└ Mute conversation

Message Templates:

- “Hi [Name], I’m raising a [Stage] round for [Company] in [Sector]...”
- “Thanks for connecting! I’d love to share our pitch deck...”
- “Are you open to a 15-minute call next week?”

Technical Stack:

- WebSocket for real-time messaging
- Message persistence in PostgreSQL
- File storage in S3
- Push notifications via Firebase

2.2 Advanced Search & Discovery

User Story:

As an investor, I want to filter founders by sector and stage so that I can find deals matching my thesis.

Search Interface:

Filters:

Location ▼

Stage ▼

Sector ▼

Check ▼

Sort by: Relevance ▼

234 results

Filter Options:

Category	Options
Location	Bangalore, Mumbai, Delhi NCR, Chennai, Hyderabad, Pune, Tier-2 Cities, Remote
Stage	Idea, Pre-seed, Seed, Series A, Series B+, Growth
Sector	Fintech, HealthTech, EdTech, SaaS, E-commerce, AI/ML, Consumer, B2B, Climate, Deeptech
Check Size	\$10K-\$50K, \$50K-\$250K, \$250K-\$1M, \$1M-\$5M, \$5M+
Role	Full-time, Co-founder, Advisor, Consultant

Saved Searches:

- Allow users to save search combinations
- Email alerts for new matches
- Weekly digest of new profiles

2.3 Profile Verification System

User Story:

As a user, I want to verify my profile so that others trust my identity and credentials.

Verification Levels:

Verification Tiers	
 Basic (Email)	Email verified
 Standard (LinkedIn)	LinkedIn connected
 Gold (Work Email)	Work email verified
 Platinum (Manual)	ID verified + background check

Verification Flow:

1. User clicks “Verify Profile”
2. Select verification method
3. Complete OAuth/Email verification
4. Badge appears on profile
5. Higher match priority

Benefits by Tier:

Tier	Badge	Match Priority	Trust Score
Basic		Standard	60%
Standard		+10%	75%
Gold		+25%	85%
Platinum		+40%	95%

2.4 Analytics Dashboard

User Story:

As a founder, I want to see how many investors viewed my profile so that I can gauge interest.

Dashboard Components:

For Founders:

Founder Analytics		
Profile Views	Investor Interest	Match Rate
1,234	56	23%
+12%	+5	+3%
Top Viewing Investors	Recent Activity	
1. Blume Ventures	• Meera I. viewed your profile (2h ago)	
2. Sequoia India	• New match: Siddharth	
3. Accel Partners	• Your intro accepted by Ananya B.	
4. Matrix Partners		
5. Lightspeed		

For Investors:

- Deal flow metrics
- Response rate tracking
- Portfolio founder activity
- Sector breakdown

For Talent:

- Profile views from founders
- Application tracking
- Skill match analytics

Phase 3: Growth Features (3-6 Months)

3.1 Referral Program

User Story:

As a user, I want to invite my network to Cleo so that we can all benefit from better connections.

Referral System:

- Referral Program:
- Unique referral link per user
 - Referral tracking dashboard
 - Reward tiers:
 - 1 referral: Premium features for 1 month

- └─ 5 referrals: Premium features for 6 months
- └─ 10 referrals: Lifetime premium access
- └─ 25 referrals: Become a community ambassador
- └─ Referral status tracking
- └─ Automated reward distribution

Rewards Table:

Referrals	Reward	Status
1	1 month Premium	📁 Claimed
5	6 months Premium	🔒 Locked (3/5)
10	Lifetime Premium	🔒 Locked (3/10)
25	Ambassador Badge + Perks	🔒 Locked (3/25)

3.2 Events & Community

User Story:

As a founder, I want to attend virtual pitch events so that I can meet multiple investors at once.

Event Types:

1. Virtual Pitch Sessions

- 5-minute pitches
- Investor Q&A
- Recording available
- Follow-up matching

2. Industry Meetups

- Sector-specific (Fintech, HealthTech, etc.)
- Panel discussions
- Networking breakout rooms

3. Office Hours

- Book 1:1 time with VCs
- Calendar integration
- Reminder notifications

4. Workshops

- Fundraising masterclass
- Pitch deck review
- Term sheet negotiation

Event Page Design:

Upcoming Events	
Featured	
Fintech Founder Pitch Night	Jan 15, 6 PM

12 investors attending • 8 spots left		[Register]	
This Week			
HealthTech Panel: Trends 2026		Jan 12, 4 PM	
45 attending		[Register]	
[View All Events]			

3.3 Content Platform

User Story:

As a founder, I want to read success stories so that I can learn from others' fundraising journeys.

Content Types:

- Success Stories**
 - Founder journey interviews
 - Fundraising playbooks
 - Before/after metrics
- Investor Insights**
 - Thesis deep-dives
 - Portfolio updates
 - Market analysis
- Talent Spotlights**
 - Career transitions
 - Skill development tips
 - Salary benchmarks
- Industry Reports**
 - Quarterly funding reports
 - Sector analysis
 - Trend predictions

Phase 4: Premium Monetization (6+ Months)

4.1 Subscription Tiers

Pricing Strategy:

Choose Your Plan		
FREE	PRO	ENTERPRISE
₹0/month	₹999/month	Custom

Basic matching	Everything in Free	Everything
3 intros/month	Unlimited intros	Team seats
Basic profile	Priority matching	API access
Analytics	Advanced analytics	White-label
Featured	Featured profile	Dedicated
	In-app messaging	support
	Event discounts	Custom
	Verified badge	features
[Get Started]	[Start Free Trial]	[Contact]

Feature Comparison:

Feature	Free	Pro	Enterprise
Profile	Basic	Featured	Custom
Intros/Month	3	Unlimited	Unlimited
Match Priority	Standard	+25%	+50%
Analytics	Basic	Advanced	Custom
Messaging	✗	✓	✓
Events	Pay-per-event	50% off	Free
Verification	Email	Gold	Platinum
Support	Community	Priority	Dedicated

4.2 Featured Listings

User Story:

As a founder, I want to boost my profile visibility so that more investors see my startup.

Boost Options:

- **7-Day Boost:** 499
- **30-Day Boost:** 1,499
- **Featured Founder:** 4,999/month

Benefits:

- Appear at top of search results
- Featured on homepage
- Priority in investor feeds
- “Featured” badge on profile

Phase 5: Platform Expansion (12+ Months)

5.1 Geographic Expansion

Target Markets:

- 1. **Southeast Asia** (Singapore, Indonesia, Vietnam)
- 2. **Middle East** (Dubai, Saudi Arabia)
- 3. **Europe** (London, Berlin, Amsterdam)

Localization Requirements:

- Multi-language support
- Local investor networks
- Regional event partnerships
- Currency and compliance

5.2 Mobile App

Platform: iOS & Android

Key Features: - Push notifications for matches

- Push notifications for matches
- Quick intro approvals
- Event check-ins
- Offline profile viewing

5.3 API & Integrations

Public API Endpoints:

GET /api/v1/profiles	# Search profiles
GET /api/v1/matches	# Get matches
POST /api/v1/intros	# Request introduction
GET /api/v1/analytics	# User analytics

Integrations:

- Slack: Match notifications
- Calendar: Event scheduling
- CRM: Investor pipeline tracking
- LinkedIn: Profile import

Implementation Roadmap

Q1 2026 (Current)
└─ Week 1-2: Bug fixes, mobile nav
└─ Week 3-4: Loading states, form validation

└─ Month 2-3: Messaging system MVP

Q2 2026

- └─ Advanced search & filters
- └─ Profile verification
- └─ Analytics dashboard
- └─ Referral program

Q3 2026

- └─ Events platform
- └─ Content hub
- └─ Premium tiers launch
- └─ Featured listings

Q4 2026

- └─ Mobile app beta
- └─ API v1 release
- └─ Geographic expansion
- └─ Enterprise features

Success Metrics

Engagement Metrics

Metric	Current	Target (6mo)	Target (12mo)
DAU/MAU	-	20%	30%
Avg Session	-	8 min	12 min
Messages/Week	-	5	10
Event Attendance	-	100	500

Growth Metrics

Metric	Current	Target (6mo)	Target (12mo)
Total Users	12,000	25,000	50,000
Monthly Signups	-	2,000	4,000
Referral Rate	-	15%	25%
Retention (30d)	-	40%	50%

Revenue Metrics

Metric	Target (6mo)	Target (12mo)
Premium Users	500	2,000
MRR	5L	25L
ARPU	1,000	1,500
Enterprise Clients	5	20

Appendix: Technical Specifications

Database Schema (Messaging)

```
CREATE TABLE conversations (  
  id UUID PRIMARY KEY,  
  participant_1_id UUID REFERENCES users(id),  
  participant_2_id UUID REFERENCES users(id),  
  created_at TIMESTAMP,  
  last_message_at TIMESTAMP  
);  
  
CREATE TABLE messages (  
  id UUID PRIMARY KEY,  
  conversation_id UUID REFERENCES conversations(id),  
  sender_id UUID REFERENCES users(id),  
  content TEXT,  
  attachments JSONB,  
  read_at TIMESTAMP,  
  created_at TIMESTAMP  
);
```

API Response Format

```
{  
  "success": true,  
  "data": {  
    "matches": [  
      {  
        "id": "uuid",  
        "name": "Meera Iyer",  
        "role": "Partner",  
        "company": "Blume Ventures",  
        "match_score": 94,  
        "sector": "Fintech",  
        "stage": "Seed"  
      }  
    ]  
  },  
  "meta": {  
    "total": 234,  
    "page": 1,  
    "per_page": 20  
  }  
}
```

Document Version: 1.0

Last Updated: March 24, 2026

Next Review: April 24, 2026